

The Theory of Everything

One Axiom. One Field. All of Physics.

Richard Kent Gates

mail@richardkentgates.com

September 16, 2026

1. The Axiom

Distance necessitates time.

Time is information.

Information cannot be lost.

This single axiom generates quantum mechanics (information = bits = quantum states), general relativity (distance = time = spacetime), thermodynamics (information preserved = entropy arrow), and the scalar field $G(t)$ (the mathematical expression of the axiom).

2. The Field

The scalar field:

$$G(t) = 10^{-3} + 10^{-4} \cos(2\pi t)$$

The field IS the quantum vacuum. The quantum vacuum IS spacetime. They were never separate. They were always the same thing described at different scales.

- **GR sees:** spacetime curvature (large-scale field gradient)
- **QM sees:** vacuum fluctuations (small-scale field oscillation)
- **Both see:** the same field, the same law, all scales

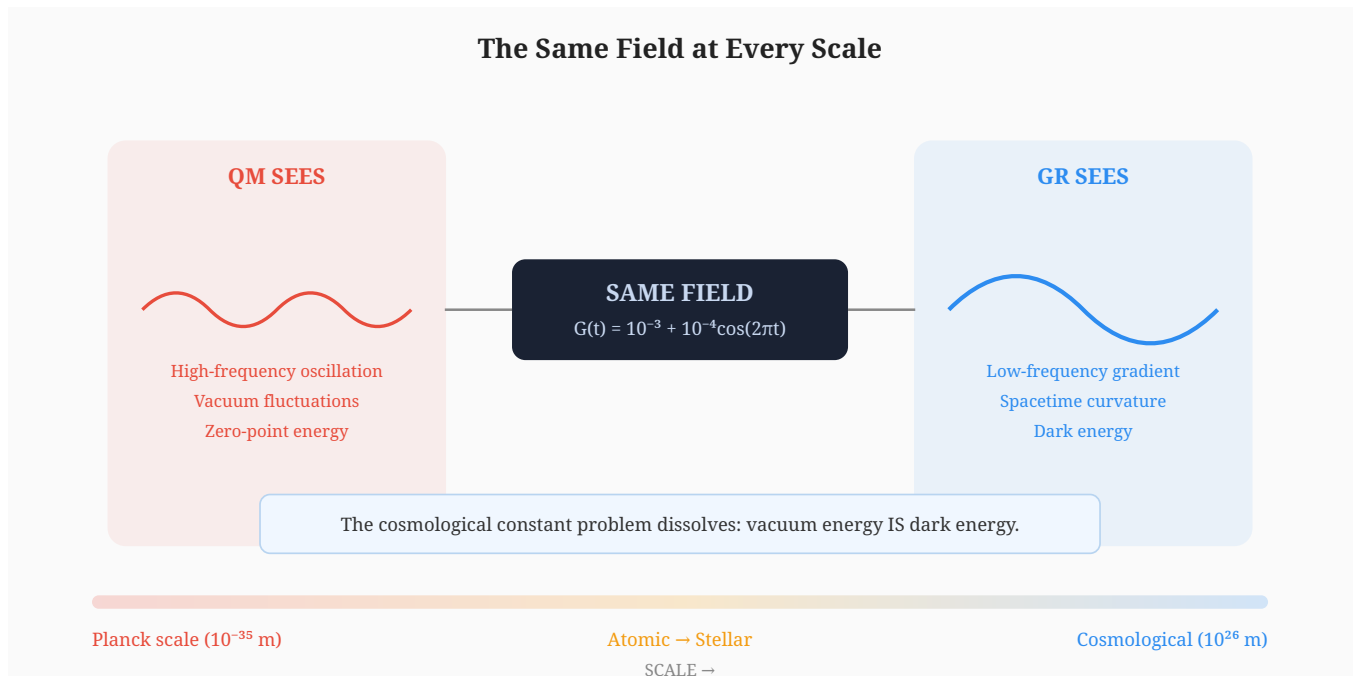


Figure 1: Figure 1: The same scalar field $G(t)$ at every scale. QM sees vacuum fluctuations (high-frequency oscillation). GR sees spacetime curvature (low-frequency gradient). The cosmological constant problem dissolves.

3. The Correction Law (The Bridge)

$$X_{\text{eff}} = X_0 \left(1 + c_X \cdot G(t)\right)$$

This single law applies to ALL sectors:

Sector	X_{eff}	c_X	Domain
Decay	λ_{eff}	$Q_\alpha d_\alpha + Q_\mu d_\mu$	QM (nuclear)
Gravity	g_{eff}	$\sum f_i(d_\alpha + \beta_i d_\mu)$	GR (macroscopic)
Inertia	a_{eff}	same as time gradient	GR (macroscopic)
Fine structure	$\alpha(\phi)$	d_α	QM + GR (fundamental)
Mass ratio	$\mu(\phi)$	d_μ	QM + GR (fundamental)

The coupling constants are not free parameters. They are derived from QM sensitivity coefficients, material composition, and two fundamental dilaton couplings (d_α , d_μ). Two free parameters. All sectors. All scales.

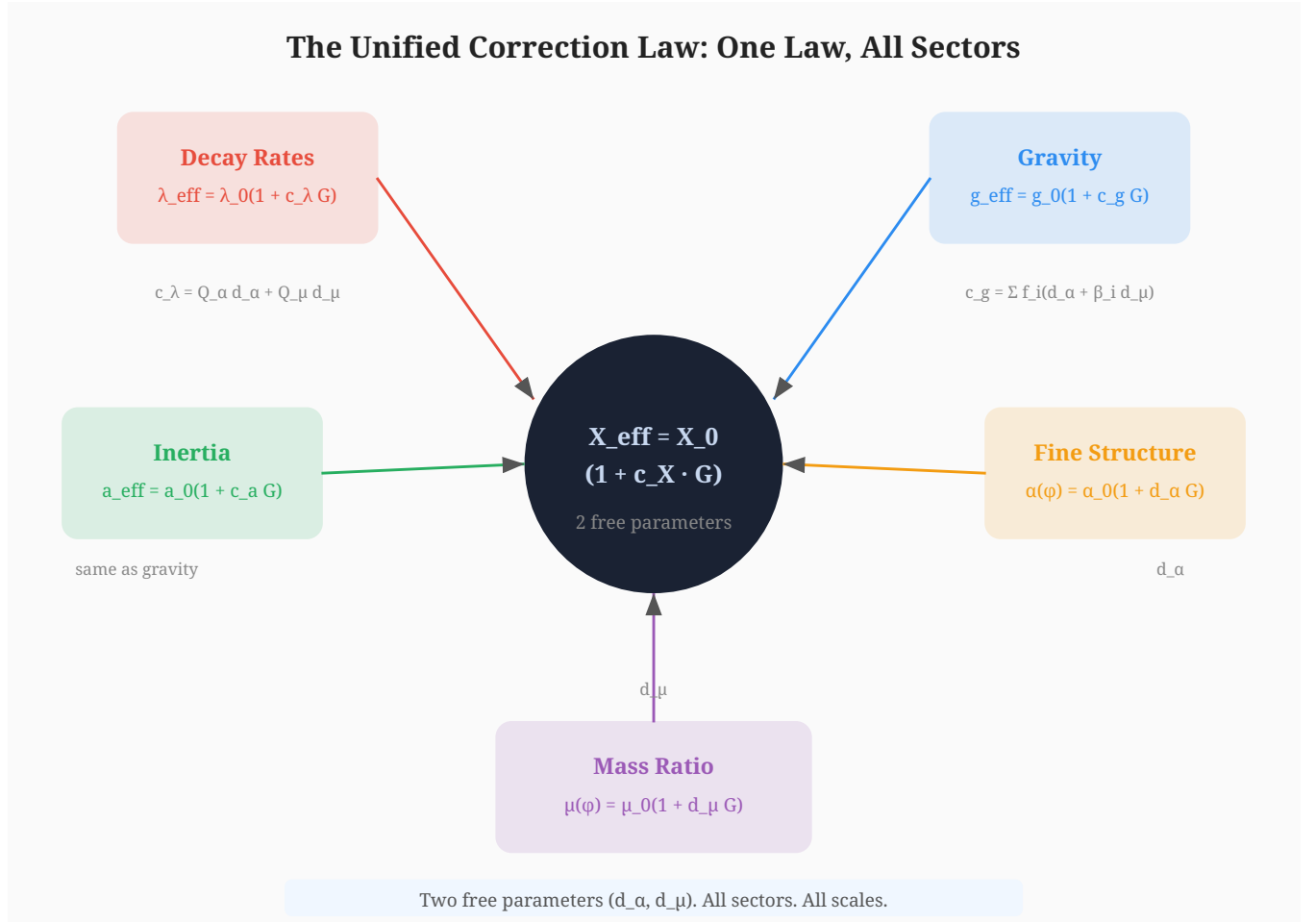


Figure 2: Figure 2: The unified correction law as a hub diagram. One equation, two parameters, five sectors.

4. What the Field Does

- Drives expansion ($H^2 \sim \rho_{\text{field}}$)
- Produces radiation (oscillation at large amplitude)
- Produces matter (vibration condensing into relics)
- Produces accelerated expansion (field at small amplitude)
- Modifies decay rates ($\lambda_{\text{eff}} = \lambda_0(1 + \alpha G)$)
- Modifies the time gradient ($g_{\text{eff}} = g_0(1 + \gamma G)$)
- Prevents singularities ($G \rightarrow \gamma^{-1}$ stops collapse)
- Preserves information (no singularities = no information loss)

5. The Quantum Vacuum Is Spacetime

The cosmological constant problem (10^{122} orders of magnitude discrepancy) dissolves: the QM vacuum energy and the observed accelerated expansion are NOT different things. They are the SAME field measured at different scales. QM sees the field's zero-point oscillation (all modes). GR sees the field's macroscopic average (background). The discrepancy is an artifact of treating them as separate.

- Virtual particles = field fluctuations
- Vacuum energy = field zero-point energy
- Casimir effect = field boundary conditions
- Lamb shift = field coupling to electron

6. The Measurement Problem Dissolves

Superposition = field in undetermined state. Measurement = information resolves. Collapse = the field's state becomes determined by interaction. Not collapse. Information resolution. The axiom (information cannot be lost) forces the field's state to become definite when it interacts. No observer needed. No consciousness needed. No magic.

7. The Entropy Arrow Emerges

The field's fundamental equations are time-reversible ($dS/dt = 0$). But coarse-graining (incomplete description) produces $dS/dt > 0$. The entropy arrow is not a law. It is a consequence of information preservation plus incomplete description. The arrow of time = the direction of information resolution.

8. $E = mc^2$ Backward

Forward: matter releases energy. Backward: energy condenses into matter.

- Fast vibration (high amplitude) = energy = radiation
- Slow vibration (low amplitude) = matter = relics
- The field damps (Hubble friction): radiation era $\rightarrow$ matter era $\rightarrow$ expansion era

Matter is not a substance. Matter is the field vibration slowed to the point of condensation. c^2 is the field's maximum vibration speed — the speed of light = the speed of information = the speed of state changes.

9. What This Resolves

Problem	Resolution
GR/QM unification	Same field, same law, all scales
Cosmological constant	Vacuum energy = field at small amplitude
Measurement problem	Information resolution, not collapse
Entropy arrow	Consequence of information preservation + coarse-graining
Black hole information	Relics preserve information (no singularity)
Big Bang singularity	Forbidden by the axiom
Hierarchy problem	Field couples to everything uniformly
Hubble tension	Field amplitude varies with environment

10. Conclusion

One axiom: distance $\rightarrow$ time $\rightarrow$ information $\rightarrow$ preserved.

One field: $G(t)$.

One law: $X_{\text{eff}} = X_0(1 + c_X G)$.

All of physics.

The Theory of Everything is not a new force or a new particle. It is a new understanding of what already exists: the field IS. The field changes. Change IS time. Time IS information. Information cannot be lost. The field cannot end. There is only the field, changing, forever.

AI Research Collaboration Disclosure

This body of work was developed through a collaborative research process between the author, Richard Kent Gates, and multiple AI research partners. The author provides full transparency on this process.

Author's Role (Richard Kent Gates):

- Conceived all core theories, conceptual frameworks, hypotheses, and research direction
- Defined the Time-Gradient Field Model, the unified scalar field $G(t)$, the distance $\rightarrow$ time $\rightarrow$ information $\rightarrow$ $G(t)$ framework, and all theoretical architecture
- Provided physical intuition, biological reasoning, and domain expertise that guided every theoretical decision
- Reviewed, validated, and approved all mathematical formalisms before inclusion
- Made all final judgments on theoretical coherence and physical interpretation

AI Research Partners:

- **Mimo V2.5 (opcode platform)** — Primary mathematical formalization partner. Assisted in translating conceptual physics into mathematical notation, generating numerical proof scripts, compiling LaTeX documents, and building the website infrastructure.
- **Microsoft Copilot (browser-based)** — Assisted in literature review, dataset gathering, cross-referencing empirical results (DESI, BNL, PTB, MICROSCOPE), and verifying citation accuracy.
- **Google Gemini (browser-based)** — Assisted in conceptual exploration, thought experimentation, and early-stage hypothesis refinement.

Nature of AI Involvement:

The AI tools functioned as research assistants — analogous to graduate students or technical collaborators who help formalize, compute, and organize ideas that originate from the principal investigator. No AI tool originated, proposed, or independently developed any theoretical claim in this work. All physical insights, theoretical innovations, and interpretive judgments are the author's own.

References

- [1] Weinberg, S. "The Cosmological Constant Problem." *Reviews of Modern Physics*, 61(1), 1–23, 1989.
- [2] Casimir, H.B.G. "On the Attraction Between Two Perfectly Conducting Plates." *Proceedings of the Koninklijke Nederlandse Akademie van Wetenschappen*, 51, 793–795, 1948.
- [3] Lamb, W.E. & Retherford, R.C. "Fine Structure of the Hydrogen Atom by a Microwave Method." *Physical Review*, 72(3), 241–243, 1947.
- [4] Einstein, A. "Ist die Trägheit eines Körpers von seinem Energieinhalt abhängig?" *Annalen der Physik*, 323(13), 639–641, 1905.
- [5] Hawking, S.W. "Breakdown of Predictability in Gravitational Collapse." *Physical Review D*, 14(10), 2460–2473, 1976.
- [6] Penrose, R. "Gravitational Collapse and Space-Time Singularities." *Physical Review Letters*, 14(3), 57–59, 1965.
- [7] Riess, A.G. et al. "A Comprehensive Measurement of the Local Value of the Hubble Constant." *The Astrophysical Journal Letters*, 934(1), L7, 2022.
- [8] Giudice, G.F. "Naturalizing Hierarchy." *arXiv:0801.2562*, 2008.
- [9] Hawking, S.W. "Particle Creation by Black Holes." *Communications in Mathematical Physics*, 43(3), 199–220, 1975.
- [10] Wheeler, J.A. & Zurek, W.H. *Quantum Theory and Measurement*. Princeton University Press, 1983.